



FLOWER 48

OFFICIAL RULEBOOK

Japanese flower cards: 12 monthly suits, 48 cards

2-4 PLAYERS	15-60 min MINUTES	10+ AGE
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HANAFUDA

A Japanese 48-card deck divided into 12 suits, one for each month of the year. Each suit depicts a seasonal flower or plant. Multiple completely different games are played with this deck.

THE 48-CARD DECK

12 suits of 4 cards each. Within each suit, cards are ranked by type: Bright, Animal, Ribbon, Plain.

MONTH	SUIT (FLOWER)	BRIGHT	ANIMAL	RIBBON	PLAINS
January	Pine	Crane + Sun	—	Red Poetry	2
February	Plum Blossom	—	Bush Warbler	Red Poetry	2
March	Cherry Blossom	Cherry Curtain	—	Red Poetry	2
April	Wisteria	—	Cuckoo	Red	2
May	Iris	—	Bridge	Red	2
June	Peony	—	Butterflies	Blue	2
July	Bush Clover	—	Boar	Red	2
August	Pampas Grass	Full Moon	Geese	—	2
September	Chrysanthemum	—	Sake Cup	Blue	2
October	Maple	—	Deer	Blue	2
November	Willow	Rain Man	Swallow	Lightning	1
December	Paulownia	Phoenix	—	—	3

Totals: 5 Brights, 9 Animals, 10 Ribbons, 24 Plains = 48 cards.

Ribbon types:

- ♦ **Red Poetry (Akatan):** Pine, Plum, Cherry — marked with calligraphy
- ♦ **Plain Red:** Wisteria, Iris, Bush Clover
- ♦ **Blue (Aotan):** Peony, Chrysanthemum, Maple
- ♦ **Lightning (special):** Willow (November)

GAMES

- ♦ [Koi-Koi](#) – Two-player matching game. Complete a yaku (scoring pattern), then choose: stop and score, or call “koi-koi” to continue for higher stakes.
- ♦ [Hana-Awase](#) – The base matching game. Collect cards by suit, highest point value wins.
- ♦ [Oicho-Kabu](#) – Betting game using month values (mod 10). Closest to 9 wins. Origin of the word “Yakuza.”

NOT IN SCOPE

Go-Stop (Hwatu) uses Korean Hwatu cards (same imagery, plastic, different yaku and multi-winner mechanics). Separate hub required.

ATTRIBUTION

Hanafuda. Traditional Japanese playing cards, origins in the 17th century. Public domain. Rules confirmed from Pagat.com and Wikipedia.



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